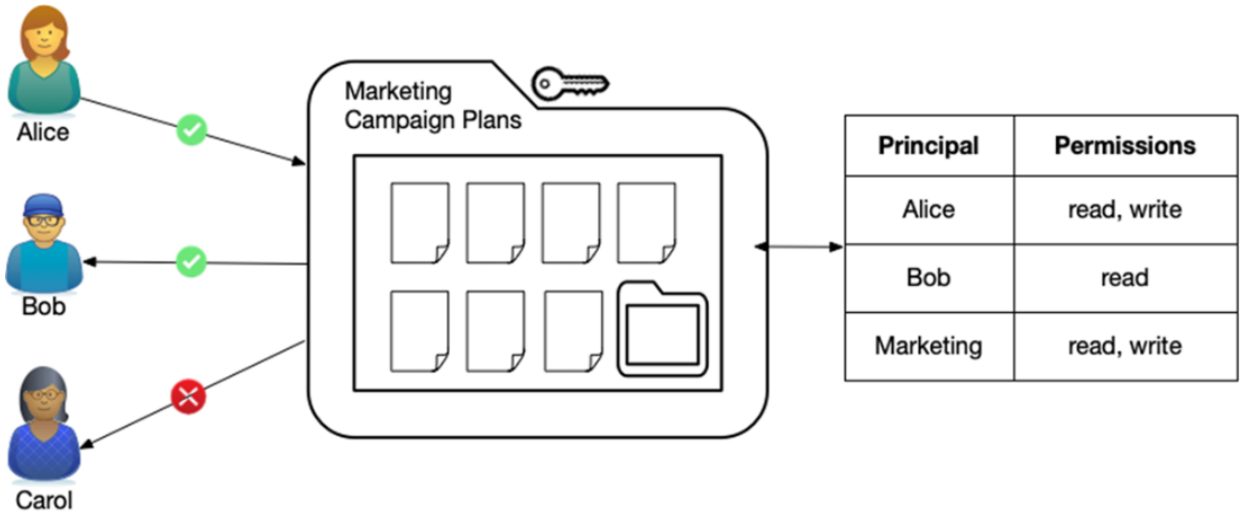


Figure 5.1 An Access Control List (ACL) attached to a shared resource. The ACL specifies which principals—such as Alice, Bob, and the Marketing group—are authorized to access the "Marketing Campaign Plans" folder and outlines the actions they are allowed to perform.

When Alice tries to write to the folder, she's allowed. Similarly, when Bob tries to read from the folder, he's allowed. However, Carol, who is not on the Marketing team, is not allowed to read from the folder.

ACLs are well-suited to environments where resource ownership is clear and relatively static or where the permission set is pre-determined and fixed. They remain widely used in operating systems, file systems, and legacy applications where simple, direct access control is sufficient.